

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

The Programmer Interview

The country's software industry is ever-growing, and no doubt most of you out there are preparing yourselves for the numerous opportunities out there—you don't even have to know how to code (you'll be trained eventually, of course)! It's a competitive world, so here we are to provide you with that extra edge to ensure that you shine with top-notch code monkey potential on your big day.

OOP: Object Oriented Programming is a programming model that relies on representing real world *objects* in your code. Using analogies with reality then makes it easier for you to design your program. There's obviously a lot more to this, so make sure you read up before wantonly dropping it into an interview. In general, praise it, for it is good.

SDLC: The Software (or System) Development Life Cycle is a bunch of procedures and documents that take a software project from a neat idea to a saleable product. There's the analysis, planning, design, coding, testing and finally the maintenance of the product. A sufficiently vague statement would be, "I think current SDLC models are long overdue for a revamp."

Garbage Collector: A feature of Java and the .net frameworks, the garbage collector is a process that cleans the system's memory of objects and variables that programs aren't using. So if you're asked how you're going to go about cleaning the memory in, say, C#, it's a trick question—you don't really need to—the garbage collector does it.

Classifieds: A novel concept, and what you'll need if you really try to bluff your way through a technical interview.

Wild Wild Web

Overflowing Bu**ers

Here's an instance where we just *can't* continue to use the stars to block objectionable letters. A reader directed a popular portal to www.mcafee.com/uk, which talks blithely about "common vulnerabilities such as SQL injection and bugger overflows."

What's cool is that McAfee sat up and took notice, and actually changed it to "buffer"—which, of course, is what they meant. The line's loss is mourned.

However, we Googled. "Bugger overflow" produces mostly news of this latest finding on buggers—that they can overflow—but there are some innocent sites out there that haven't sat up and taken notice.

For instance, <http://snipurl.com/wwwdec1> states that Adobe had sometime issued an alert stating that a bug in Acrobat has a serious flaw, "and opening a malicious PDF could trigger a bugger overflow."

Even the buggers of the world are probably wonder-

ing why, how and when they "overflow."

Keeping It Simple

You know about those Nigerian scam e-mails: "I have a gazillion bajillion dollars and would like to deposit it someplace... I am a king/prince... co-operate... send me your bank details..." You probably also know that hundreds of people have actually fallen prey to these poor excuses for phishing scams. So they're now cutting to the chase. Here's the latest 419er doing the rounds:

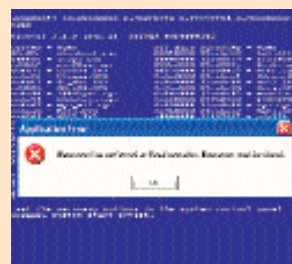
"Dear Sir/Madam, I am Mrs Minrada Subaja Rahul. I have a project I'd like to execute with you. Kindly get back to me with your full details. Remain Blessed." Period.

A Doomed Sense Of Humour?

It's Official: Microsoft has developed a sense of humour! We won't reveal all here: head to www.microsoft.com/technet/sysinternals/Miscellaneous/BlueScreen.mspx where you can download the Bluescreen BSOD screensaver.

We'll leave most of the rest to you—it's worth a visit!—but here's an actual snippet: "Use Bluescreen to amaze your friends and scare your enemies!" Now that *is* sporty!

But there's (possibly) a tragic twist to it. We also found that *Bluescreen* had crashed, as in the screenshot below... a tragic ending to a sweet development if ever there was one.



But perhaps not. The site we got this screenshot from is in a ridiculously non-English language, spouting such obscene sentences as "Brata-blizniaka, albo bardzo nieladnie zdublowal sobie." So we didn't understand what was actually happening, and the screenshot could have been fabricated.

tumour. At Google, when you do "internet addiction," you'll get the Refine option which lists out the following: Treatment, Tests/Diagnosis, From Medical Authorities, Symptoms, Causes/Risk factors, Alternative medicine, and more!

Currently in such news is Nichola Webb, a clinical psychologist in Australia. Here's her bleat: "Many are not aware they are suffering an Internet addiction, given society's encouragement of Internet use."

"I've found their Internet usage, in whatever excessive form, often provides a means of escape from their personal problems..."

Studies in the US and South-East Asia are "clearly establishing that Internet addiction is a reality," says

Dr Mubarak Rahamathulla of Flinders University, Australia.

We don't like these words—"expert," "clinical psychologist," and so on. Experts say this, experts say that. Why is a lot of Internet use called an "addiction," we ask. We also ask, why spend money and resources on what is patently a pseudo-problem?

Let's compare "Internet Addiction" with smoking. Smoking kills, gaming heals. Smoking causes withdrawal symptoms, surfing doesn't. Smoking is no use, browsing increases awareness. Smoking is for when you're bored, getting online is for when you're in touch with life, the universe and everything. Anyway, that's not the point.

Experts say (here we go again) we're very soon

going to reach the next level of evolution. They say we'll be alien-like, with large heads and eyes and small bodies. Experts also say we'll be living in the virtual world all the time, and have little use for our bodies. (We're making all this up as we go along.) In fact, experts say, our brains will be wired directly to the Net.

OK, if we quit the silly made-up-stuff, here's what we genuinely believe: that we are evolving—changing—to be more virtual and less real. Does any *Digit* reader seriously doubt that in 20 years time, we'll be on the Internet all the time? What will they say about "Internet Addiction" then?

The truth is clear: online is where it's at. Outdoor's overrated. Don't they get that?